ASSESSMENT TOOL II

Name	**B Akshaya**
Register Number	**192424336**
Date	**13-10-2026**

COURSE CODE: ITA1420

COURSE NAME: Ethical Hacking

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO1: Apply the principle of the foundational concepts of ethical hacking, including types of hackers, ethical principles, legal frameworks, and the role of responsible disclosure in cybersecurity.

Activity Tool: Ethical Debate (Medium)
Assessment Tool Weightage: 20%

Code of Conduct:

I B Akshaya [192424336] (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment.I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the student: Akshaya

Rubrics for Calculation

Criteria	Weightage (%)	Level 4 (Exemplary)	Level 3 (Proficient)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 1 (Beginning)
Conceptual Understanding	30%	Demonstrates thorough understanding of ethical hacking concepts, legal requirements, and ethical principles.	Demonstrates good understanding with minor gaps.	Demonstrates partial understanding with several conceptual errors.	Demonstrates limited understanding of ethical hacking concepts.
Argument Quality and Accuracy	25%	Presents accurate, logical arguments supported by relevant facts and examples.	Presents mostly accurate arguments with minor errors.	Presents arguments with limited evidence and some inaccuracies.	Presents unclear arguments with major inaccuracies.
Application of Ethical Principles	20%	Effectively applies authorization, confidentiality, responsible disclosure, and legal principles to scenarios.	Applies ethical principles appropriately with minor errors.	Applies some ethical principles but struggles with scenario-based decisions.	Fails to apply relevant ethical and legal principles.
Communication and Participation	15%	Communicates clearly, presents ideas confidently, and actively participates in the debate.	Communicates effectively and participates regularly.	Communicates ideas inconsistently and participates minimally.	Communicates poorly and shows little participation.
Critical Thinking and Rebuttal	10%	Evaluates opposing views logically and provides strong, evidence-based counterarguments.	Responds to opposing views with reasonable arguments.	Provides limited counterarguments with weak reasoning.	Cannot evaluate opposing views or provide relevant counterargument

scenario 2 – Public Interest vs. Organizational Reputation

Scenario: An ethical hacker discovers a serious vulnerability in a widely used online banking application. The bank delays responding to the vulnerability report because public disclosure may affect its reputation.

Debate Topic: *Should the ethical hacker disclose the vulnerability publicly to protect customers, even if the organization has not approved disclosure?*

1. **Should an ethical hacker publicly disclose a serious vulnerability if the bank delays fixing it?**

Ans: **For Public Disclosure**

1. Protects customers from financial fraud and data theft.
2. Creates public awareness about cybersecurity risks.
3. Pressures the bank to fix the vulnerability quickly.
4. Promotes transparency and accountability.
5. Helps prevent further harm to customers.

Against Public Disclosure

1. Cybercriminals may exploit the vulnerability.
2. Customers may face financial losses.
3. The bank may lose its reputation and customer trust.
4. Unauthorized disclosure may lead to legal consequences.
5. Immediate disclosure may not give the bank enough time to fix the vulnerability.

2. Should an ethical hacker give the bank a reasonable deadline to fix the vulnerability before public disclosure?

Yes, customer protection is more important

1. Protects customers' personal and financial information.
2. Prevents financial fraud and cyberattacks.
3. Builds public trust through transparency.
4. Ensures the organization takes cybersecurity seriously.
5. Prioritizes public safety over business reputation.

No, organizational reputation also matters

1. Public disclosure may create panic among customers.
2. The organization may lose customer trust and business.
3. Cybercriminals may exploit the disclosed vulnerability.
4. Financial losses may affect employees and stakeholders.
5. Responsible private reporting gives the organization time to fix the issue securely.

3. Should the government or a cybersecurity authority intervene if the bank ignores the vulnerability report?

Yes, they should intervene

1. Protects customers from potential cyberattacks and financial fraud.
2. Forces the bank to take the vulnerability seriously.
3. Ensures the bank follows cybersecurity laws and regulations.
4. Helps investigate the vulnerability and recommend security measures.
5. Promotes accountability and strengthens public trust in online banking.

Concerns about intervention

1. Government intervention may damage the bank's reputation.
2. Investigations may take considerable time and resources.

3. Public attention may alert cybercriminals to the vulnerability.
4. Strict intervention may increase the bank's financial burden.
5. Premature intervention may disrupt banking services and customer transactions.

4. Can delaying disclosure put customers' personal and financial information at risk?

Yes, delaying disclosure can put customers at risk

1. Cybercriminals may exploit the vulnerability while it remains unfixed.
2. Customers' personal information may be stolen.
3. Unauthorized transactions and financial fraud may occur.
4. Delayed action can increase the number of affected customers.
5. Early warnings through appropriate channels can help protect customers.

Reasons to delay public disclosure

1. Immediate disclosure may help cybercriminals identify the vulnerability.
2. The bank needs time to investigate and fix the security issue.
3. Premature disclosure may create unnecessary panic among customers.
4. Delaying public disclosure allows security teams to test the solution.
5. Confidential reporting can protect customers while the bank works on a fix.

5. Should an ethical hacker give the bank a reasonable deadline to fix the vulnerability before public disclosure?

Ethical

1. Gives the bank time to fix the vulnerability.
2. Protects customers from potential cyberattacks.
3. Follows responsible disclosure practices.
4. Encourages the bank to improve security.
5. Balances customer safety with confidentiality.

Against giving a deadline

1. The bank may continue delaying the security fix.
2. Customers may remain at risk during the delay.
3. Cybercriminals may exploit the vulnerability before it is fixed.
4. The bank may ignore the report even after the deadline.
5. A long deadline may increase the possibility of financial fraud.